

Non-contextual meanings and functional readings of *wh*-questions

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1 Introduction

Three readings of a *wh*-question with a quantifier:

- (1) Q: Who does everyone love?
 A: Sue (individual reading)
 A': Their mother. (functional reading)
 A'': John loves Sue; Bill loves Mary; Tim loves Amy. (list reading)

Proposal by many linguists like Groenendijk and Stokhof (1984), Engdahl (1980, 1986), and Chierchia (1993), Hornstein (1995), Sharvit (1997,1999), Dayal (1996, 2016), Xiang (2023), etc.:

A *wh*-phrase with a functional reading carries two or more indexes, one of which is bound by a *wh*-phrase and the other(s) by (a) quantifier(s).

- (2) Who_{*i*} does everyone_{*j*} love t_i^j ?
 [who f does [everyone_{*x*} love $f(x)$]]

4 Problems

- In natural language syntax, it has been assumed that a movement of a phrase leaves one trace with one index.
- If the *wh*-phrase denotes a function, it should be *what*, not *who*.
- If there is more than one quantifier in a sentence, the trace of a *wh*-phrase may need three or more indexes.

- (3) a. Q: To whom does every writer dedicate a book?
 A: To the person that inspired her/him to write it.
- b. $[[\text{to whom}]_i [\text{every writer}]_j [\text{a book}]_k [t_j \text{ dedicates } t_k t_i^{j,k}]]$
- c. $\lambda p \exists f [p = \forall x [\text{writer}(x) \rightarrow \exists y [\text{book}(y) \wedge \text{dedicate}(x, y, f(x, y))]]]$

- In the short answer *Their mother* in (1), the pronoun is free.

(4) $\llbracket \text{Their mother} \rrbracket = \iota x[\text{mother}(x, y)]$
Cf. Required interpretation: $\lambda y \iota x[\text{mother}(x, y)]$

Purpose of this paper

To propose an analysis that assumes a single-indexed trace and that lacks the problems

2 Necessity of non-contextual meanings

2.1 Problems with binding relations

Reconstruction required:

In *wh*-questions, if a preposed phrase includes a DP that is subject to Binding Conditions (BCs), it must be reconstructed into the positions of its trace.

- (5) a. *Which of *each other*'s friends did she remind t that *they* saw Bill?
 b. Which of *each other*'s friends did *they* remind t that she saw Bill?
 c. Which of *each other*'s friends did she remind Bill that *they* saw t ?

- (6) *Whose examination of *John* did *he* fear?
 ⇒ *did *he* fear whose examination of *John* ?

It is reasonable to assume that **all preposed *wh*-phrases should be reconstructed.**

Intervention effects:

A *wh*-phrase cannot occur after a focused phrase.

- (7) a. ??When did [only John_F] visit which museum?
 b. Which museum did [only John_F] visit?

- (8) Which of *each other*'s friends did she remind [only Bill_F] that *they* saw t?

⇒ We must get the reconstruction effect without actually putting a *wh*-phrase back.

It is reasonable to assume that **all preposed *wh*-phrase are not reconstructed but get the effect of reconstruction somehow.**

2.2 Non-contextual meanings

Intervention effects + Reconstruction effects $\Rightarrow$

- A preposed *wh*-phrase must be interpreted so that it has the scope of its trace.

Question 1: How is a preposed *wh*-phrase interpreted?

- If a preposed *wh*-phrase has the scope of its trace, it is likely to behave like a *wh*-phrase in situ.

Question 2: How is a *wh*-phrase in situ associated with the Mood?

Answer to Question 1: Non-contextual meanings

- An expression is usually interpreted w.r.t. a linguistic context.
- A linguistic context is $\langle g, w \rangle$, where g and w are an assignment and a possible world.
- The meaning of an expression with the feature $[+wh]$ is a non-contextual meaning.

non-contextual meaning of A : $\lambda \langle g, w \rangle \llbracket \alpha \rrbracket^{gw}$

- A *wh*-phrase and its trace carries the feature of $[+wh]$.
- A non-contextual meaning is contextualized with respect to a local context if the expression is in an IP.

$$(9) \quad \begin{array}{ccccccc} [_{MP} & \text{Wh-phrase}_i & & \dots & [_{IP} & \dots & t_i^{[+wh]} & \dots & \text{wh-phrase} & \dots]] \\ & \text{non-contextual} & & & & & \text{non-contextual} & & \text{non-contextual} & \\ & \text{not contextualized} & & & & & \text{contextualized} & & \text{contextualized} & \end{array}$$

- For the trace of a *wh*-phrase, we need a new assignment that assigns a non-contextual meaning.

Contextual assignments: $f, g, \dots$

Non-contextual assignments: $\vec{f}, \vec{g}, \dots$

$$(10) \quad \llbracket t_k^{[+wh]} \rrbracket^{\vec{g}g^*w^*} = \vec{g}(k)(\langle g^*, w^* \rangle)$$

- (5) c. $[_{MP}[_{DP}\text{Which of } \textit{each other}_j\text{'s friends}]_k \text{ did she}_i \text{ remind Bill that } \textit{they}_j \text{ saw } t_k^{[+wh]} ?]$
 $\lambda\langle g, w \rangle \llbracket \text{Which of each other's friends} \rrbracket^{\vec{g}g, w} (= A)$
 $\llbracket \text{did she}_i \text{ remind Bill that } \textit{they}_j \text{ saw } t_k^{[+wh]} \rrbracket^{\vec{g}g^*w^*} =$
 $\llbracket \text{did} \rrbracket^{g^*w^*} (\llbracket \text{remind} \rrbracket^{g^*w^*} (g^*(i), \textit{bill}, \lambda w' [\llbracket \text{saw} \rrbracket^{g^*w'} (g^*(j), \vec{g}(k)(\langle g^*, w' \rangle))]))))$
- $\llbracket \text{Which of } \textit{each other}\text{'s friends did she remind Bill that } \textit{they} \text{ saw } t \rrbracket^{\vec{g}g^*w^*}$
 $= \lambda \vec{x} [\llbracket \text{did she}_i \text{ remind Bill that } \textit{they}_j \text{ saw } t_k^{[+wh]} \rrbracket^{\vec{g}[k/\vec{x}]g^*w^*} (A)$
 $= [\llbracket \text{did} \rrbracket^{g^*w^*} (\llbracket \text{remind} \rrbracket^{g^*w^*} (g^*(i), \textit{bill}, \lambda w' [\llbracket \text{saw} \rrbracket^{g^*w'} (g^*(j), A(\langle g^*, w' \rangle))])))]$
 $= [\llbracket \text{did} \rrbracket^{g^*w^*} (\llbracket \text{remind} \rrbracket^{g^*w^*} (g^*(i), \textit{bill},$
 $\quad \lambda w' [\llbracket \text{saw} \rrbracket^{g^*w'} (g^*(j), \llbracket \text{Which of each other's friends} \rrbracket^{g^*, w'})])))]$
 $= \llbracket \text{did she remind Bill that } \textit{they} \text{ saw Which of } \textit{each other}\text{'s friends} \rrbracket^{\vec{g}g^*w^*}$

This gives the effect of reconstruction.

Semantics of the interrogative Mood

- The meaning of *did*: $\llbracket \text{did} \rrbracket : \text{a proposition} \rightarrow \text{a pair of propositions}$

$$\llbracket \text{did} \rrbracket(\llbracket \phi \rrbracket) = \{\langle p, \neg p \rangle \mid p \in \llbracket \phi \rrbracket \text{ or } p = \llbracket \phi \rrbracket\}$$

Assumption: The meaning of an IP is a proposition.

- (11) a. Did John laugh?
 $\{\lambda w \llbracket \text{John laughed} \rrbracket^w, \lambda w [\neg [\llbracket \text{John laughed} \rrbracket^w]]\}$
- b. Who did John love?
 $\{\{\lambda w [\llbracket \text{loved} \rrbracket^w(d)(john)], \lambda w [\neg [\llbracket \text{loved} \rrbracket^w(d)(john)]]\} \mid d \in D\}$
 $= POW(\{\lambda w [\llbracket \text{loved} \rrbracket^w(d)(john)] \mid d \in D\})$

Question 2: How is a *wh*-phrase in situ associated with the Mood?

Answer to Question 2: Alternative non-contextual meanings

- A *wh*-word generates a set of alternatives, meanings.
- The alternatives also denote non-contextual meanings.

- (12) $\text{Who}_j^{[+wh]}$ does John believe every boy_{*i*} loves $t_j^{[+wh]}$?
 $\Rightarrow \llbracket [M \text{ **does**}] \text{ John believe } [\text{every boy}]_i \text{ loves } \text{Who}_j^{[+wh]} \rrbracket \vec{g}gw$
- a. $??POW(\{\lambda w'[\text{John believe}^{w'}(\lambda w''[\forall x[\text{boy}^{w''}(x) \rightarrow \text{love}^{w''}(x,y)]]]) \mid y \in \text{Alt}(\llbracket \text{who}_j \rrbracket \vec{g}gw)\})$ (main context)
- b. $??POW(\{\lambda w'[\text{John believe}^{w'}(\lambda w''[\forall x[\text{boy}^{w''}(x) \rightarrow \text{love}^{w''}(x,y)]]]) \mid y \in \text{Alt}(\llbracket \text{who}_j \rrbracket \vec{g}g[i/x]w'')\})$ (local context)
- c. $\checkmark POW(\{\lambda w'[\text{John believe}^{w'}(\lambda w''[\forall x[\text{boy}^{w''}(x) \rightarrow \text{love}^{w''}(x,\vec{y}^{g[i/x]w''})]]]) \mid \vec{y} \in \text{Alt}(\llbracket \text{who}_j^{[+wh]} \rrbracket \vec{g}[j/\vec{y}]gw)\})$ (non-contextual)

- (12a) leads to the individual reading.

- (12b) is not available because i) x in $g[i/x]$ is free and ii) something introduced in the scope of a universal quantifier or a modal operator is not available in the main context.

- (13) a. ??Every man has *a car*. *It* is not fast.
 b. ??Amy thinks Bob has *a car*. *It* is not fast.

- (12c) is the only possible reading.

Results:

i) A preposed *wh*-phrase gets the effect of reconstruction and is associated with the Mood by denoting a set of alternative non-contextual meanings.

Question 3: Why is a *wh*-phrase preposed?

ii) A non-contextual meaning is scopeless.

Question 4: How is the scope of a *wh*-phrase determined?

2.3 Why is a *wh*-phrase preposed?

- In languages like Korean and Japanese, no *wh*-movement is necessary.
- In English, if there is more than one *wh*-phrase in a question, only one is preposed.
- The scope of a *wh*-phrase in situ is not subject to syntactic islands, though a *wh*-movement is.

(14) Which linguist will be offended if [we invite *which philosopher*]?

- A preposed *wh*-phrase does not have the scope that a DP normally gets in the surface position. A *wh*-movement is not for the scope of the *wh*-phrase.

(15) A: John is insane. He believes {a hero in a movie, an imaginary creature} attacked him.

B: {Who, What} does John believe attacked him?

A: {Iron Man, A unicorn}.

- The classical analyses of *wh*-questions like Hamblin (1973) and Karttunen (1977) are not quite right.

(16) $\lambda p \exists x [person/animal(x) \wedge p = \hat{believe}(john, \hat{attack}(x, john))]$

Answer to Question 3: In English, a *wh*-movement is to indicate the scope of a question, not the scope of the *wh*-phrase.

2.4 How is the scope of a *wh*-phrase determined?

- A *wh*-phrase is generally taken to be an indefinite.
- An indefinite has three interpretations.

(17) If *a relative of mine* dies, I will inherit a house.

- If there is *a relative of mine* and he or she dies, I will inherit a house.
- (I live with three relatives of mine.) If *a relative of mine* dies,
- (I live with a relative mine.) If *the relative of mine* dies,

(18) $\llbracket [a \ \alpha] \ \beta \rrbracket =$

- a. $\lambda P \exists x [\llbracket \alpha \rrbracket(x) \wedge \llbracket \beta \rrbracket(x)]$ (quantificational use)
- b. $\ll \exists X [X \neq \emptyset \wedge \forall x \in X [\llbracket \alpha \rrbracket(x)]] \gg \exists x' \in X [\llbracket \beta \rrbracket(x')]$ (split scope)
Only the **descriptive content** is presupposed.
- c. $\ll \exists x [\llbracket \alpha \rrbracket(x)] \gg \llbracket \beta \rrbracket(x)$ (specific use)
Both the **quantificational force** and the **descriptive content** are presupposed.

- A *wh*-phrase is a specific indefinite, whose scope is determined by presupposition projection of the quantificational force and the descriptive content.

- (19)
- a. If John stops smoking, he will get healthier.
= John has been smoking. If John stops it, he will get healthier.
 - b. If *a relative of mine* dies, I will inherit a house.
= There is a relative of mine. If she dies, I will inherit a house.

- A *wh*-phrase as a specific indefinite tends to have wide scope, but despite the tendency, it can have narrow or intermediate scope if it is required.

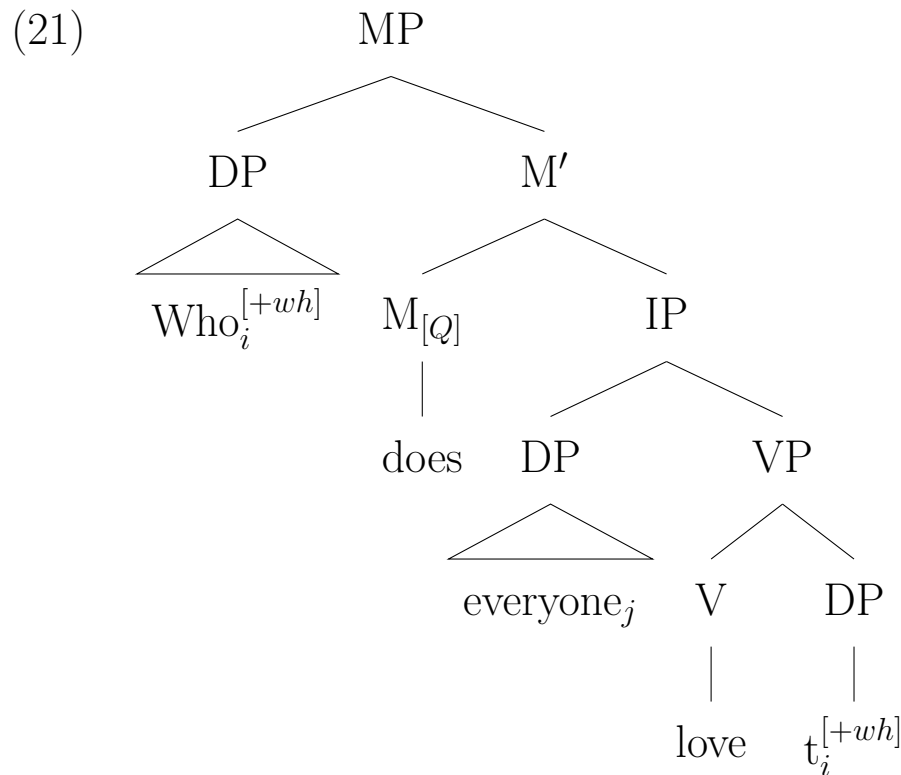
- (20) Everyone drove *his car*.
= Everyone who has a car drove it.
≠ There is a car. Every boy drove it.

- This explains the functional reading of a *wh*-question with a quantifier.

3 Non-contextual meaning and functional *wh*-questions

3.1 Interpretation of a *wh*-question with the functional reading

- The structure of a *wh*-question with a functional reading:



Interpretation of a *wh*-phrase as a specific indefinite:

– A *wh*-word generates a set of alternative values of non-contextual meanings

- (22) a. $\llbracket [_{DP} \textit{which}^{[+wh]} \alpha]_i^{[+wh]} \rrbracket \vec{g}g^w = \lambda \langle g', w' \rangle \llbracket [_{DP} \textit{which}^{[+wh]} \alpha]_i \rrbracket \vec{g}g'w'$
 $= \{ \lambda \langle g', w' \rangle [\ll \pi \gg \vec{x}^{g'[i/y]w'}] : \vec{x} \in \textit{Alt}(\vec{g}(i)) \}$
 $\pi = \exists y [\llbracket \alpha \rrbracket \vec{g}g'[i/y]w'(\vec{x}^{g'[i/y]w'})]$, where $\langle g'[i/y], w' \rangle$ is in the domain of $\vec{x}$.
- b. π is accommodated in a linguistic context $g''w''$ in the following way:
 $\pi \Rightarrow \vec{\pi}$ (abstracted over contexts) $\Rightarrow \vec{\pi}^{g''w''}$ (contextualized)

- Some *wh*-words can be assumed to include some descriptive content.

- (23) who = which person;
 where = which place;
 when = which time
 (*which* here is number-neutral)

- Compositional interpretation of a *wh*-question with the functional reading

- (24) a. $\llbracket t_i^{[+wh]} \rrbracket \vec{g}gw = \vec{g}(i)^{gw}$
- b. $\llbracket t_j \text{ love } t_i^{[+wh]} \rrbracket \vec{g}gw = \text{love}^w(g(j), \vec{g}(i)^{gw})$
- c. $\llbracket \wedge [\text{everyone}_j [t_j \text{ love } t_i^{[+wh]}]] \rrbracket \vec{g}gw$
 $= \lambda w' [\lambda P \forall x [\text{person}^{w'}(x) \rightarrow P(x)] (\lambda z \llbracket t_j \text{ love } t_i^{[+wh]} \rrbracket \vec{g}g[j/z]w')]$
 $= \lambda w' \forall x [\text{person}^{w'}(x) \rightarrow \text{love}^{w'}(x, \vec{g}(i)^{g[j/x]w'})]$
- d. $\llbracket \text{does } \wedge [\text{everyone}_j [t_j \text{ love } t_i^{[+wh]}]] \rrbracket \vec{g}gw$
 $= \langle \lambda w' \forall x [\text{person}^{w'}(x) \rightarrow \text{love}^{w'}(x, \vec{g}(i)^{g[j/x]w'})],$
 $\lambda w' \neg \forall x [\text{person}^{w'}(x) \rightarrow \text{love}^{w'}(x, \vec{g}(i)^{g[j/x]w'})] \rangle$
- e. $\llbracket \text{Who}_i^{[+wh]} \rrbracket \vec{g}gw = \llbracket [\text{Which}^{[+wh]} \text{ person}]_i^{[+wh]} \rrbracket \vec{g}gw$
 $= \{ \lambda \langle g', w' \rangle [\ll \pi \gg \vec{x}^{g'[i/y]w'}] : \vec{x} \in \text{Alt}(\vec{g}(i)) \}, \text{ where}$
 $\pi: \exists y [\text{person}^{w'}(\vec{x}^{g'[i/y]w'})]$
- f. $\llbracket \text{Who}_i^{[+wh]} \text{ does } \wedge [\text{everyone}_j [t_j \text{ love } t_i^{[+wh]}]] \rrbracket \vec{g}gw =$
 $\{ \lambda \vec{z} \llbracket \text{does } \wedge [\text{everyone}_j [t_j \text{ love } t_i^{[+wh]}]] \rrbracket \vec{g}[i/\vec{z}]^{gw}(\vec{x}) \mid \vec{x} \in \llbracket \text{Who}_i^{[+wh]} \rrbracket \vec{g}gw \}$
 $= \text{POW}(\{ \lambda w' \forall x [\text{person}^{w'}(x) \rightarrow \text{love}^{w'}(x, \ll \pi \gg \vec{x}^{g[i/y][j/x]w'})] \mid \vec{x} \in \text{Alt}(\vec{g}(i)) \})$
 $= \text{POW}(\{ \lambda w' \forall x [\text{person}^{w'}(x) \rightarrow \ll \exists y [\text{person}^{w'}(\vec{x}^{g[i/y][j/x]w'})] \gg$
 $\text{love}^{w'}(x, \vec{x}^{g[i/y][j/x]w'}) \mid \vec{x} \in \text{Alt}(\vec{g}(i)) \})$

- The speaker assumes a set of alternatives $\vec{x}$ that look like the one in (25).

$$(25) \quad \vec{x} = \begin{bmatrix} g_1 w' \rightarrow c_1^{w'} \\ g_2 w' \rightarrow c_2^{w'} \\ g_3 w' \rightarrow c_3^{w'} \\ \dots & \dots & \dots \end{bmatrix}, \text{ where } g_1, g_2, g_3, \dots \text{ are s.t. } \begin{bmatrix} g_1(j)^{w'} = a_1^{w'} \\ g_2(j)^{w'} = a_2^{w'} \\ g_3(j)^{w'} = a_3^{w'} \\ \dots \end{bmatrix},$$

where c_n is in a relation of natural function to a_n .

- What if the presupposition from the *wh*-phrase is accommodated over the universal quantifier, as in (26), with the same alternative non-contextual values of $\vec{x}$?

Answer: $\vec{x}^{g[i/y][j/x]w'}$ is not defined.

$$(26) \quad POW(\{\lambda w' \ll \exists y[person^{w'}(\vec{x}^{g[i/y]w'})] \gg \forall x[person^{w'}(x) \rightarrow love^{w'}(x, \vec{x}^{g[i/y][j/x]w'})] \mid \vec{x} \in Alt(\vec{g}(i))\})$$

- A case where (1) has an individual reading:

$$(27) \quad \vec{x} = \begin{bmatrix} g_1 w \rightarrow c_1^{w'} \\ g_2 w \rightarrow c_1^{w'} \\ g_3 w \rightarrow c_1^{w'} \\ \dots & \dots & \dots \end{bmatrix}, \text{ where } g_1, g_2, \dots \text{ are s.t. } \begin{bmatrix} g_1(j)^{w'} = a_1^{w'} \\ g_2(j)^{w'} = a_2^{w'} \\ g_3(j)^{w'} = a_3^{w'} \\ \dots \end{bmatrix}$$

- What if the presupposition from the *wh*-phrase is not projected to the main context?

Answer: The interpretation itself has no problem, but if a question is asked with the functional reading, non-contextual values like the one in (27) are excluded from the context.

3.2 Problems with a multiply-indexed trace solved

- The meaning of personhood of *who* is reflected in the meaning of $person^{w'}(\vec{x}^{g'[i/y]w'})$ in (24).

$$(24) \quad f. \quad \llbracket \text{Who}_i^{[+wh]} \text{ does } \wedge [\text{everyone}_j [t_j \text{ love } t_i^{[+wh]}]] \rrbracket \vec{g}gw = \\ Pow(\{ \lambda w' \forall x [person^{w'}(x) \rightarrow \ll \exists y [person^{w'}(\vec{x}^{g[i/y][j/x]w'})] \gg \\ love^{w'}(x, \vec{x}^{g[i/y][j/x]w'})] \mid \vec{x} \in Alt(\vec{g}(i)) \}) \setminus \emptyset$$

- A non-contextual value of a trace with one index includes in its domain all possible contextual assignments which assign values to indexes of other DPs.
- We do not have to look at other parts of a sentence in interpreting the trace of a *wh*-phrase.

$$(28) \quad \vec{x} = \begin{bmatrix} g_1 w' \rightarrow c_1^{w'} \\ g_2 w' \rightarrow c_2^{w'} \\ g_3 w' \rightarrow c_3^{w'} \\ \dots \quad \dots \quad \dots \end{bmatrix}, \text{ where } g_1, g_2, \dots, g_n, \dots \text{ are s.t.}$$

$g_n(k)^{w'}$ is in a functional relation to $\langle g_n(i)^{w'}, g_n(j)^{w'} \rangle$.

- A short answer can be interpreted with no free variable: The short answer *Their_j mother*, for example, is interpreted as denoting $\lambda\langle g'w' \rangle \iota z[mother^{w'}(z, g'(j))]$ where there is no free variable.

4 Conclusion

A *wh*-phrase introduces a set of alternative non-contextual meanings, which are scopeless, and the scope of a *wh*-phrase, which is a specific indefinite, is determined by the presupposition projection.

Appendix

4.1 Basic semantics for *wh*-questions

- A Model

(29) A Model $M = \langle W, D, F, C \rangle$, where
 W is a set of possible worlds,
 $D = \bigcup \{D^w \mid w \in W\}$ is a set of individuals,
 F is an interpretation function for lexical items, and
 C specifies counterpart relations between individuals in different possible worlds.

- Contextual and non-contextual assignments

(30) a. G is a set of functions from a set of natural numbers N into a set of semantic entities of various semantic types.

e.g. $\llbracket [t_i]_{DP} \rrbracket^{\vec{g}gw} = g(i)^w$

- b. $\vec{G}$ is a set of functions from N to a set of functions from subsets of $G \times W$ to semantic entities denoted w.r.t. assignment-world pairs in the subsets.

e.g. $\llbracket [t_i^{[+wh]}]_{DP} \rrbracket^{\vec{g}gw} = \vec{g}(i), \quad \text{where} \quad \vec{g}(i) =$
 $\lambda \langle g'w' \rangle \in \mathbf{g} \times \mathbf{w} [g'(i)^{w'}], \text{ where}$
 $\mathbf{g} \subseteq G \text{ and } \mathbf{w} \subseteq W.$

$$\vec{g}(i) = \begin{bmatrix} g_1w' \rightarrow d_1(= g_1(i)^{w'}) \\ g_2w' \rightarrow d_2(= g_2(i)^{w'}) \\ g_3w' \rightarrow d_3(= g_3(i)^{w'}) \\ \dots \quad \dots \quad \dots \end{bmatrix}$$

- A proper name, an intransitive and a transitive verb

(31) a. If α is a proper name, $\llbracket \alpha \rrbracket^{\vec{g}gw} = F(\alpha)^w$

e.g. $\llbracket \text{John} \rrbracket^{\vec{g}gw} = F(\text{John})^w = jo^w$

b. $\llbracket [_{IV} \alpha] \rrbracket^{\vec{g}gw} = \lambda x [F(\alpha)^w(x)];$

c. $\llbracket [_{TV} \alpha] \rrbracket^{\vec{g}gw} = \lambda y \lambda x [F(\alpha)^w(y)(x)]$

- A VP and an IP

$$(32) \quad \begin{aligned} \llbracket_{VP} \alpha \llbracket_V \gamma \rrbracket \beta \rrbracket \rrbracket^{\vec{g}gw} &= \llbracket \gamma \rrbracket^{\vec{g}gw} (\llbracket \beta \rrbracket^{\vec{g}gw}) (\llbracket \alpha \rrbracket^{\vec{g}gw}) \\ \llbracket_{IP} \hat{\alpha} \rrbracket^{\vec{g}gw} &= \lambda w' \llbracket \alpha \rrbracket^{\vec{g}gw'} \end{aligned}$$

- A quantifier

$$(33) \quad \begin{aligned} &\text{If } Q \text{ is a quantificational determiner,} \\ \llbracket_{DP} Q \alpha \rrbracket_i \beta \rrbracket \rrbracket^{\vec{g}gw} &= [\llbracket Q \rrbracket^{\vec{g}gw} (\llbracket \alpha \rrbracket^{\vec{g}gw}) (\lambda x^w [\llbracket \beta \rrbracket^{\vec{g}g[i/x]w})]]. \end{aligned}$$

Depending on whether each of the two daughters denotes a set of meanings, the whole expression is interpreted as in (34a), (34b) or (34c). Normal interpretations are defined with A and B and the rest are to deal with non-contextual meanings. In this way, a set of meanings is maintained up to an interrogative M.

$$(34) \quad \llbracket [\gamma \ \alpha \ \beta] \rrbracket^{\vec{g}gw} =$$

- a. $\{\ll \pi_1, \pi_2 \gg C : \vec{x} \in \text{Alt}(\vec{g}(i)), \vec{y} \in \text{Alt}(\vec{g}(j))\}$ if $\llbracket \alpha \rrbracket^{\vec{g}gw} = \{\ll \pi_1 \gg A : \vec{x} \in \text{Alt}(\vec{g}(i))\}$ & $\llbracket \beta \rrbracket^{\vec{g}gw} = \{\ll \pi_2 \gg B : \vec{y} \in \text{Alt}(\vec{g}(j))\}$;
- b. $\{\ll \pi \gg C : \vec{x} \in \text{Alt}(\vec{g}(i))\}$ if $\llbracket \alpha \rrbracket^{\vec{g}gw} = \{\ll \pi \gg A : \vec{x} \in \text{Alt}(\vec{g}(i))\}$ & $\llbracket \beta \rrbracket^{\vec{g}gw} = B$;
- c. C , if $\llbracket \alpha \rrbracket^{\vec{g}gw} = A$ and $\llbracket \beta \rrbracket^{\vec{g}gw} = B$.
($C = A(B)$ or $B(A)$, depending on the semantic types of α and β .)